CARGO INDUSTRY

A 1990s-style transport tycoon where you build the industry, hire the workers and move the cargo by rail, road, water and air

A solo developer's single-player strategy game for PC puts the whole supply chain in the player's hands, from the first coal mine to livestock ships on the lakes and coal flown in by cargo plane. It was released on Steam on 17 September 2026.



Key art: the Cargo Industry logo framed by all four transport modes, a steam train, a cargo airplane, a container ship and a truck, over an isometric world of mines, farms, a power station, city blocks, a station and a steel bridge.

For anyone who spent the 1990s laying track in *Transport Tycoon* or running factories in *Industry Giant*, **Cargo Industry** will feel familiar within minutes, and then quietly different. It is a single-player transportation and industrial management strategy game in which the player builds rail, road, sea and air links across a freshly generated world, decides where every factory stands, staffs it, and earns money only by moving raw materials and finished goods.

The game is designed, programmed and produced by one person, **Martin Timothy Timko**, under the label Indicatrix Studio. It runs on Windows 10 and 11, is built in Unity, and has been available on Steam since 17 September 2026. There are no passengers, no combat and no timer: the entire economy is cargo, and the pressure is the player's own ambition.

Your factories, your map

Most transport tycoons hand the player an industrial map and ask for a network to serve it. Cargo Industry reverses that. Nothing is pre-placed: the player chooses both the location and the type of every one of sixteen facilities, from coal, iron, gold and silver mines to oil wells, farms and forests, and on to sawmills, smelters, refineries, power stations and electronics and furniture factories.

Placement is bounded by the physical world. Terrain elevation, water, trees, rocks and existing cities all block construction, so a good site is something the player earns by reading the map. Every 256×256 tile world is generated anew, which means the best layout from the last game is useless in the next one.



Nine of the sixteen facility types the player can build, among them the coal mine, electronics factory, farm, forest, power station, sawmill and smelter.

Hire before you produce

A factory in Cargo Industry does nothing until someone works there. Borrowing the spirit of *Theme Hospital*, every facility needs an assigned worker, hired from a roster of sixteen professions that mirrors the factory set: miners, oil drillers, farmers and woodcutters on one side; sawyers, butchers, millers, metallurgists, glassmakers and electronics technicians on the other.

Each profession has its own painted portrait and job description, and each hire is made at a low, medium or high salary. Wages are a running cost rather than a one-off purchase, so expansion is never just a question of whether the player can afford the building.



The Staff Management screen at Windford, here hiring an Electronics Tech on a high salary: sixteen professions, an illustrated portrait for each and three salary tiers.

A chain that has to close

Sixteen raw materials and products flow through the economy. Coal feeds power stations. Iron, gold and silver ore all go to the smelter, whose metals are needed by the glass factory and by the two most demanding plants in the game: the electronics factory, which combines plastic, glass and metals, and the furniture factory, which adds boards to the same list. Farms supply both livestock and grain, forests supply sawmills, and oil wells supply the refinery.

Revenue is earned only when cargo arrives at a facility that accepts it, and that revenue pays for everything: track, roads, docks, airports, trains, trucks, ships, airplanes, factories and wages. The multi-input plants are where separate supply lines, sometimes arriving by land, water and air at once, have to meet, and where a network is really tested.



The strategic map over Stoneford in Terrain view; it also switches to Industry, Rail and Road views, with a colour key for every facility type.

Bridges at every level

Water and high ground are no longer walls. Both rail and road can be carried across lakes and rivers on three kinds of bridge, a stone arch viaduct, a steel truss bridge or a red suspension span, and driven through hills in tunnels.

What sets Cargo Industry apart from *OpenTTD* is height. Bridges cannot be built directly on top of one another, but they can be built above height level 1, which OpenTTD does not allow, so a line can cross a valley at the height of the surrounding hills.

Where rail and road meet at ground level, they do not have to avoid each other either: mixed rail–road crossings let both networks share the same corridors and the same towns.

Bridges above height level 1, each at its own elevation.



Brightmoor: a timber train crosses the lake on a red suspension bridge, from the forest at Brightmoor North to the sawmill at Brightmoor Central.



All three bridge types side by side across one valley: the red suspension bridge, the steel truss bridge and the stone arch viaduct, with the build cursor laying a new line and the Rail Construction panel open.



The suspension bridge in its road and rail versions, and the road and rail tunnel portals.



Depots and stations for all four modes: rail depot and station, road depot and station, an airport, and a dock depot and dock station on the shore.



Day and night mode on the same city: the world darkens and the tower windows light up.

Four fleets, one economy

Rail, road, water and air are four separate build systems, each with its own construction panel, stations, depots and fleet. Rail offers three locomotives, among them the *Iron Dragon* and the *Thunderbolt*, and sixteen wagon types; road offers sixteen cargo vehicles.

On the water, docks on lakes and rivers serve cargo ships such as the livestock ship. In the air, two airports make a route: a coal airplane flies from a coal mine to a power station straight over hills and lakes a railway would have to bridge or tunnel.

Every train, truck, ship and airplane belongs to a depot and follows routes the player defines. If a line is demolished while a train is under way, the train simply waits, and once the connection is rebuilt it finds its way and carries on. Rebuilding a busy network is part of the game, not a punishment.

A world drawn in 1980

Every game generates a new 256×256 tile world: cities that range from clusters of low-rise houses to downtowns of glass towers, lakes and forests, and hills whose elevation the strategic map shows in five bands. The calendar starts in January 1980, with steam locomotives, period trucks and a balance kept in credits. The detailed isometric world sits under a hand-built retro interface of brass-framed parchment panels. By day the world is bright and sunlit; a night mode, switched from the toolbar, darkens it, lights up the windows of the city towers and puts lamps on the trains and stations.

In pictures



By water: a livestock ship sails from the dock beside the farm at Stoneford Central to the slaughterhouse at Millhaven Central, with the Dock Construction and Dock Depot panels open.



Goldmore by air: a coal airplane flies from Goldmore Central, next to the coal mine, to Goldmore North beside the power station, with the Airport Depot and Airport Construction panels open.



Easthaven by road: a coal truck runs through two road tunnels from the coal mine at Easthaven North to the power station at Easthaven Central, with the Road Construction and Road Depot panels open.



Redbrook and Northwick, with all four construction panels open: rail and road through tunnels and level crossings, a timber train, and a cargo airplane between two airports.



The same Redbrook and Northwick network in night mode: lit tower windows in both cities and a train's headlamp on the line.



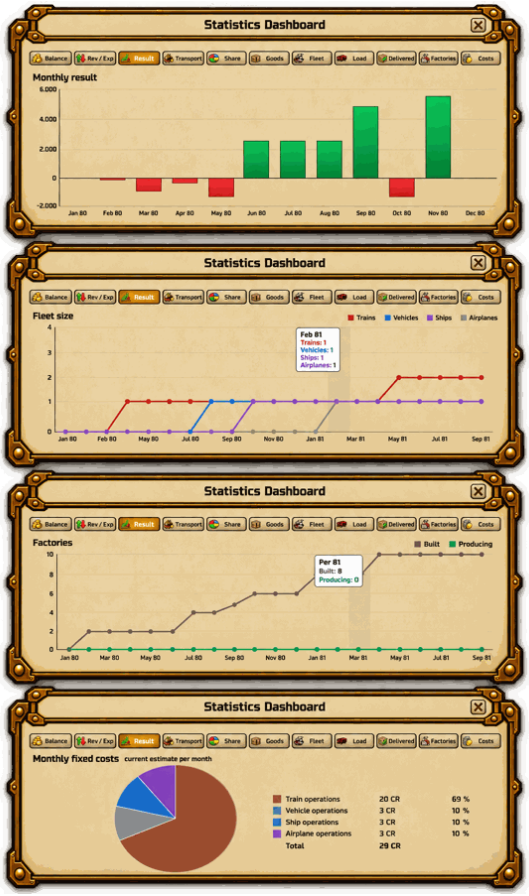
The Statistics Dashboard on the Result tab: losses in the first months of construction, then profit, with a tooltip on December 1980.

Every credit on the chart

A network spread over four transport modes needs bookkeeping to match, and Cargo Industry keeps it in a Statistics Dashboard. Eleven tabs, Balance, Revenue and Expenses, Result, Transport, Share, Goods, Fleet, Load, Delivered, Factories and Costs, chart the company month by month from the first day of the game, with a tooltip on every point.

The Result tab shows each month's profit or loss as a bar, so the expensive early months of construction are plain to see. The Fleet tab counts trains, road vehicles, ships and airplanes as separate lines, and the Factories tab compares how many facilities have been built with how many are actually producing, which is where a missing worker or an unconnected input shows up first.

The Costs tab breaks the monthly fixed costs down by mode, into train, vehicle, ship and airplane operations, with each mode's share of the total. Before the player adds another locomotive or a second airplane, the dashboard shows what the fleet already costs to run.



Four of the eleven dashboard tabs: monthly result, fleet size by transport mode, factories built and producing, and monthly fixed costs by mode.

From hobby project to finished game

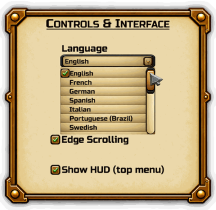
Cargo Industry began as something to work on in spare hours, and it stayed a one-person project to the end. World art is licensed from Synty Studios and the Unity Asset Store; the retro interface, the systems, the procedural generation and all of the game logic are the developer's own. In his own words:

> *"The development of this game started in July 2024 as a hobby project; I did not program every day. The initial architecture was created on 17 March 2025. Until 17 January 2026 I programmed without AI, about 40 % of the development: the basic architecture, the tile system and terrain rendering. After that I used AI, ChatGPT and Claude Sonnet and Opus. The game was completed in August 2026. The most intensive development was from April to June 2026. I gradually wrote about 25 longer prompts. The game contains a total of 86 source files, and about 20 main source files. I was inspired by games from the 1990s."*
>
> **Martin Timothy Timko**, developer, Indicatrix Studio

The AI tools were used as programming assistants, and their use is disclosed on the game's Steam page in line with Valve's requirements. All design and interface decisions are the developer's.



The Cargo Industry logo, available to press in full resolution.



The language menu: the game is localised into 25 languages.

Development timeline

JUL 2024	Project begins as a part-time hobby
17 MAR 2025	Initial architecture created
TO 17 JAN 2026	About 40 % built without AI: architecture, tile system, terrain rendering
FROM JAN 2026	AI used as a programming assistant
APR–JUN 2026	Most intensive development
AUG 2026	Game completed
17 SEP 2026	Released on Steam

Fact sheet

TITLE	Cargo Industry
GENRE	Transport and industrial management strategy
MODE	Single-player
PLATFORM	Windows 10/11 (64-bit), Steam
ENGINE	Unity
DEVELOPER	Martin Timothy Timko, Indicatrix Studio
LANGUAGE	Localised into 25 languages
STATUS	Released, available on Steam
RELEASE	17 September 2026

- Sixteen player-placed facility types
- Sixteen staff professions, three salary tiers
- Three bridge types, buildable above height level 1
- Four transport modes: rail, road, ships and airplanes
- Docks and airports with their own depots and stations
- Rail and road tunnels, mixed crossings
- Statistics dashboard with eleven chart tabs
- Procedural 256 × 256 tile worlds from 1980
- Day and night modes, switched from the toolbar

About Indicatrix Studio. Indicatrix Studio is the self-publishing label of Martin Timothy Timko, the sole developer of Cargo Industry. The game is designed, programmed and produced by one person in Unity. Screenshots, the logo, key art, factory and bridge artwork and review keys are available to press on request, and publishing enquiries are welcome.

STEAM STORE PAGE

store.steampowered.com/app/5155330

Out now on Steam.

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